Humana. **Claims Payment Policy**

Subject: Laboratory – Urine Culture Testing for Bacteria

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: LAB2023056
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Urine culture testing (CPT code 87076, CPT code 87077, CPT code 87140, CPT code 87147, CPT code 87149*, CPT code 87181, CPT code 87186) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with a primary diagnosis representing a general encounter without abnormal findings or similar examination.

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure code	Code description
87076	Culture, bacterial; anaerobic isolate, additional methods required for definitive identification, each isolate
87077	Culture, bacterial; aerobic isolate, additional methods required for definitive identification, each isolate
87140	Culture, typing; immunofluorescent method, each antiserum
87147	Culture, typing; immunologic method, other than immunofluorescence (eg, agglutination grouping), per antiserum
87149*	Culture, typing; identification by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA) probe, direct probe technique, per culture or isolate, each organism probed
87181	Susceptibility studies, antimicrobial agent; agar dilution method, per agent (eg, antibiotic gradient strip)
87186	Susceptibility studies, antimicrobial agent; microdilution or agar dilution (minimum inhibitory concentration [MIC] or breakpoint), each multi-antimicrobial, per plate

**The payment criterion for 87149 apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except for CGS Administrators, LLC, Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC, Palmetto GBA, Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation*

Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)

Contractor name	Policy title	Policy number	Procedure code
CGS Administrators, LLC	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L39038	87149
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L39001	87149

Palmetto GBA	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L38988	87149
Wisconsin Physicians Service Insurance Corporation	MolDX: Molecular Syndromic Panels for Infectious Disease Pathogen Identification Testing	L39044	87149

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